Koç University
COMP438/538 Reinforcement Learning
Proposal Rubric

Proposed rubric for instructor review
20 points, contributing 5% of the overall course grade

Criterion	Points	What earns full credit
Problem, question and related work	4	A clear motivation and focused question. Relevant sources help define or motivate the problem. A high-level, incomplete literature discussion is sufficient.
Tentative RL formulation	6	A coherent account of the agent, state/observation, actions, dynamics, reward, objective and horizon/termination, as relevant. Assumptions and important open choices are explicit.
Tentative approach and baseline	3	A plausible approach and tentative baseline, with an explanation of what the comparison would reveal. Method choices may remain provisional.
Evaluation and feasibility	5	Metrics and an intended comparison address the question. The plan considers evaluation conditions, environment/data access, compute and important risks. Estimates can be tentative.
Clarity and presentation	2	Concise, specific and organized writing, identifiable citations and compliance with the main-content limit. Avoid repetition and unsupported claims.
Total	**20**	

How to apply the rubric

- Award full credit when the criterion is met at **proposal-stage depth**. Award partial credit for useful but unclear, incomplete or inconsistent reasoning. Award little or no credit for missing or unsupported content.
- Grade the quality of the planned study. A working implementation, experimental results, exhaustive related work, novelty and benchmark superiority are not proposal requirements.
- An explicit, reasonable uncertainty is different from omitting a required part. A baseline described as tentative can earn full credit.
- Treat writing problems under clarity unless they also prevent assessment of substantive reasoning. Avoid deducting twice for the same defect.

LLM disclosure

The LLM-use report is a required disclosure, not a separate source of bonus points. Permitted, disclosed AI assistance does not by itself reduce the score. Assess the students' reasoning and ownership of the submitted proposal.

The syllabus governs nondisclosure and academic integrity. Do not infer an automatic numerical penalty from this draft. Additional penalties must be settled before release.

Grade conversion: proposal score divided by 20, multiplied by 5, gives the contribution in course percentage points.